

United States History and Geography — Teacher Key

United States History and Geography · Tennessee Academic Standards 2027-28 · Form FORM-B

TEACHER COPY — contains answer keys and rationales. Not for student distribution.

classroom-formative · pre-field-test. Item parameters are estimates and have not met a student; this form is not a calibrated instrument. This form assesses Depth of Knowledge levels 1 through 4.

1. Use the photograph to answer the question. This photograph shows the signing ceremony for the North Atlantic Treaty on April 4, 1949. The treaty created the North Atlantic Treaty Organization (NATO), a mutual defense alliance between the United States, Canada, and ten Western European nations. (Photograph, April 4, 1949. Public Domain.) What was the PRIMARY purpose of the alliance created by the treaty shown being signed in this photograph?

- A. To establish free trade among Western nations
- B. To create a unified European government
- C. To dismantle colonial empires in Asia and Africa
- D. To provide collective defense against Soviet aggression in Europe

KEY: D · DOK 1 · US.59

Why the key is right: NATO was created as a collective defense alliance against the Soviet threat. Article 5 established that an attack on one member would be considered an attack on all. This was a historic break from American tradition — the first peacetime military alliance since the founding of the republic.

A — Free trade among Western nations came through separate economic instruments — the Marshall Plan and later the OEEC. NATO's founding treaty is a mutual-defence pact.

B — No political union was created. Each member kept full sovereignty; NATO commits members to respond to an attack, not to govern jointly.

C — Several founding members were themselves colonial powers in 1949. Decolonisation was not a NATO aim and in places ran against member interests.

Item analysis

Standard

US.59 — Describe the competition between the United States and the Soviet Union in arms development, economic dominance, and ideology, including the roles of the United Nations, NATO, and the Warsaw Pact.

DOK / Hess

Level 1 — The student recalls the stated purpose of a named treaty organisation. One retrieved fact, which is DOK-1; explaining why a peacetime alliance broke with American tradition would be DOK-2.

Reporting category

— (source of record: UNMAPPED)

IRT

a 1.0 · b -1.2 · c 0.22 (pre-field-test — estimates, not calibrated against student responses)

Format

classroom-formative (tcapFormat: false — not affirmed — no human has judged this item field-testable)

Bias / sensitivity

not-started

Citation

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Historian review

required, not yet done

Distractor diagnosis

A — confuses NATO's military purpose with postwar economic cooperation; **B** — reads a defensive alliance as a step toward European political union; **C** — attributes decolonisation aims to an alliance of colonial powers

2. What was the satellite state system in Eastern Europe?

- A. Eastern European countries controlled by the Soviet Union after World War II
- B. Independent nations that voluntarily formed economic partnerships with the USSR
- C. Asian countries that cooperated on space technology with the Soviet program
- D. Western European nations that received economic aid from the United States

KEY: A · DOK 1 · US.59

Why the key is right: The satellite state system in Eastern Europe was Eastern European countries controlled by the Soviet Union after World War II. Choice C is wrong because it describes asian countries that cooperated on space technology with the Soviet program, not eastern European countries controlled by the Soviet Union after World War II. These developments defined the Cold War as a global struggle over power, ideology, and influence.

B — Participation was not voluntary. Soviet troops remained after 1945 and coalition governments were replaced by communist ones, as in Czechoslovakia in 1948.

C — The word 'satellite' here is political, not orbital — it describes a state held in another's orbit of control, and predates the space programme.

D — Nations receiving American aid were the Marshall Plan recipients in Western Europe — the opposite bloc.

Item analysis

Standard

US.59 — Describe the competition between the United States and the Soviet Union in arms development, economic dominance, and ideology, including the roles of the United Nations, NATO, and the Warsaw Pact.

DOK / Hess

Level 1 — The student recalls what a named term denoted. A single retrieved definition, which is DOK-1.

Reporting category

— (source of record: UNMAPPED)

IRT

a 0.48 · b -1.0 · c 0.2 (pre-field-test — estimates, not calibrated against student responses)

Format

classroom-formative (tcapFormat: false — not affirmed — no human has judged this item field-testable)

Bias / sensitivity

not-started

Citation

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Historian review

required, not yet done

Distractor diagnosis

B — mistakes imposed control for voluntary partnership; **C** — reads 'satellite state' as a reference to spaceflight; **D** — reverses which bloc the satellite states belonged to

3. Use the photograph to answer the question. This photograph shows the NATO treaty signing, April 4, 1949. (Photograph, 1949. Public Domain.) How did the creation of NATO, shown in this photograph, represent a departure from traditional American foreign policy?

- A. NATO was a temporary agreement that expired after five years
- B. It was the first peacetime military alliance in American history
- C. The alliance required no military commitment from the United States
- D. The United States had long maintained peacetime military alliances in Europe

KEY: B · DOK 2 · US.59

Why the key is right: Since Washington's Farewell Address warned against 'permanent alliances,' the United States had avoided binding military commitments to European nations. NATO represented a fundamental break: a permanent peacetime alliance committing the U.S. to defend Western Europe. This reflected the Cold War reality that isolationism was no longer viable against the Soviet threat.

A — The treaty carried no expiry. It has been in continuous force since 1949 and has expanded well beyond its original members.

C — Article 5 is precisely a military commitment: an attack on one is treated as an attack on all. That obligation is what made the treaty historically significant.

D — The opposite: Washington's Farewell Address warned against permanent alliances, and the United States had avoided them in peacetime for over 150 years.

Item analysis

Standard

US.59 — Describe the competition between the United States and the Soviet Union in arms development, economic dominance, and ideology, including the roles of the United Nations, NATO, and the Warsaw Pact.

DOK / Hess

Level 2 — The student must connect the fact of the treaty to what it broke with in American practice — a relationship between an event and a tradition, which is DOK-2. Naming the year or the members would be DOK-1.

Reporting category

— (source of record: UNMAPPED)

IRT

a 1.3 · b 0.1 · c 0.2 (pre-field-test — estimates, not calibrated against student responses)

Format

classroom-formative (tcapFormat: false — not affirmed — no human has judged this item field-testable)

Bias / sensitivity

not-started

Citation

—

Historian review

required, not yet done

Distractor diagnosis

A — invents a time limit the treaty does not contain; **C** — empties the alliance of the mutual-defence obligation that defines it; **D** — reverses the American tradition NATO broke with

4. How did the formation of NATO and the Warsaw Pact reflect the ideological competition between the United States and the Soviet Union during the Cold War?

- A. The alliances reflected agreement between superpowers on the need for collective disarmament
- B. Both alliances were formed primarily for economic cooperation rather than military defense
- C. They split Europe into rival military blocs, one capitalist and one communist
- D. NATO and the Warsaw Pact were created jointly to prevent a third world war between smaller nations

KEY: C · DOK 2 · US.59

Why the key is right: NATO (1949) aligned Western democracies under U.S. leadership; the Warsaw Pact (1955) formalized Soviet bloc military cooperation, institutionalizing the ideological divide across Europe.

A — Disarmament is the reverse of what followed. Both blocs expanded conventional and nuclear forces through the 1950s and 1960s.

B — Both were defence pacts. The economic instruments of the period were separate: the Marshall Plan on one side, COMECON on the other.

D — They were not created jointly and not at the same time. NATO came in 1949 and the Warsaw Pact in 1955, formed in response to it.

Item analysis

Standard

US.59 — Describe the competition between the United States and the Soviet Union in arms development, economic dominance, and ideology, including the roles of the United Nations, NATO, and the Warsaw Pact.

DOK / Hess

Level 2 — The student must read two alliance systems as expressions of an ideological contest — inferring a pattern from paired events, which is DOK-2.

Reporting category

— (source of record: UNMAPPED)

IRT

a 1.2 · b -0.2 · c 0.2 (pre-field-test — estimates, not calibrated against student responses)

Format

classroom-formative (tcapFormat: false — not affirmed — no human has judged this item field-testable)

Bias / sensitivity

not-started

Citation

—

Historian review

required, not yet done

Distractor diagnosis

A — reads an arms build-up as an agreement to disarm; **B** — confuses the military alliances with the parallel economic blocs; **D** — treats two opposing alliances as a cooperative project

5. The Cold War was fought through proxies, propaganda, espionage, and economic competition rather than direct military conflict between the U.S. and Soviet Union. Analyze WHY the Cold War took this form by examining at least THREE factors that prevented direct conflict. Then evaluate whether this "cold" form of warfare was more or less dangerous than traditional warfare.

KEY: — · DOK 3 · US.59

Why the key is right: Nuclear weapons, alliance systems, and diplomacy through the United Nations all helped keep the United States and Soviet Union from fighting each other directly. A strong response should also explain that the Cold War still caused massive suffering through proxy wars, espionage, coups, and an arms race that threatened the world with annihilation. The best essays weigh both sides and argue clearly whether avoiding direct superpower war made this form of conflict less deadly or simply dangerous in a different way.

Item analysis

Standard

US.59 — Describe the competition between the United States and the Soviet Union in arms development, economic dominance, and ideology, including the roles of the United Nations, NATO, and the Warsaw Pact.

DOK / Hess

Level 3 — The student must construct and defend an evaluation of why a conflict stayed 'cold', weighing several causes against evidence. Building and defending an argument is DOK-3.

Reporting category

— (source of record: UNMAPPED)

IRT

a 1.82 · b 0.63 · c 0.0 (pre-field-test — estimates, not calibrated against student responses)

Format

classroom-formative (tcapFormat: false — item type is never TCAP-format under policy v1)

Bias / sensitivity

not-started

Citation

—

Historian review

required, not yet done

Distractor diagnosis

no misconception named — a distractor written to be merely wrong is noise, not diagnosis

Rubric

4-point

1. **4** — Analyses THREE distinct factors that kept the superpowers from direct conflict — nuclear deterrence and the logic of mutual assured destruction, the alliance and bloc structure that made escalation collective, and the diplomatic channels and norms that developed for managing crises — and explains the MECHANISM of each, not just its name. The evaluation confronts the real difficulty: the "cold" form avoided a great-power war while producing enormous casualties in Korea, Vietnam and elsewhere, so "less dangerous" and "more dangerous" depend on who is counted. A position is taken and defended.

2. **3** — Three factors, accurately identified, with at least two explained mechanically. The evaluation takes a position and offers support, but treats the proxy-war cost briefly.
3. **2** — Two or three factors named but explained as labels. The evaluation restates that the Cold War was dangerous without weighing the comparison.
4. **1** — Fewer than two usable factors, or factors that are consequences rather than causes. No evaluation.
5. **0** — No response, or off-topic.

6. DOCUMENT-BASED QUESTION: The Marshall Plan — Economic Aid as Cold War Strategy Directions: Read the following two primary source excerpts and then respond to the prompt below. Analyze both documents using the SOAPS framework (Speaker, Occasion, Audience, Purpose, Significance) and construct an evidence-based argument. --- DOCUMENT A: Secretary of State George C. Marshall, Commencement Address at Harvard University, June 5, 1947 — U.S. government document, available through the Avalon Project, Yale Law School: "It is logical that the United States should do whatever it is able to do to assist in the return of normal economic health in the world, without which there can be no political stability and no assured peace. Our policy is directed not against any country or doctrine but against hunger, poverty, desperation, and chaos. Any government that is willing to assist in the task of recovery will find full co-operation... on the part of the United States Government. Any government which maneuvers to block the recovery of other countries cannot expect help from us." DOCUMENT B: Soviet Foreign Minister Vyacheslav Molotov, Statement rejecting the Marshall Plan, Paris Conference, July 2, 1947 — diplomatic record, available through the Avalon Project, Yale Law School: "The American plan splits Europe into two groups of states and creates new difficulties in the relations between them... The Marshall plan, which envisages for American credits various conditions infringing on the sovereignty of European countries and interfering in their home affairs... will lead to nothing but a further aggravation of relations between countries." --- Using both documents and your knowledge of Cold War economic competition (US.61, US.59), construct an argument that evaluates the Marshall Plan as a Cold War strategic instrument. Apply SOAPS analysis to both documents and address: (1) whether Marshall's stated humanitarian purpose was consistent with the Plan's actual geopolitical effects; (2) why the Soviet Union rejected the Plan and whether that rejection was strategically rational; and (3) what the exchange between these two documents reveals about the fundamental incompatibility that defined the early Cold War.

KEY: — · DOK 4 · US.59, US.63

Why the key is right: SCORING GUIDE (6 points): 6 - Exemplary: Precise, arguable thesis on the humanitarian/strategic duality. Full SOAPS analysis of both documents, identifying all five elements for each with historical accuracy. Outside evidence (minimum 3 specific facts). Addresses all three prompt components. Synthesizes the documents' dialogue to reveal structural Cold War incompatibility. 5 - Advanced: Clear thesis. Full SOAPS on both documents (may miss one element). Two pieces of outside evidence. Addresses two of three prompt components clearly. 4 - Proficient: Arguable thesis. SOAPS partially applied to both documents (3–4 elements per document). One specific outside evidence fact. Addresses two prompt components. 3 - Adequate: General thesis. Analyzes both documents but without systematic SOAPS. Some outside knowledge evident. 2 - Developing: Basic claim. References at least one document, mostly summary. Minimal outside evidence. 1 - Beginning: Attempts a response. May reference documents without analysis. 0 - No response or off-topic. DOCUMENT ANALYSIS EXPECTATIONS: Document A SOAPS — the universalist framing as strategic choice; the commencement setting as public communication platform; the invitation to all nations as a calculated gamble. Document B SOAPS — Molotov's 'sovereignty' argument as proxy for Soviet hegemony concerns; the Paris conference as the turning point that crystallized European division; the accusation of U.S. interference as revealing of Soviet satellite-state model. KEY EVIDENCE EXPECTED: \$13.3 billion in aid; Western European GDP recovery (1948–1952); OEEC creation; Molotov Plan and COMECON; Czech coup (February 1948) occurring simultaneously; Berlin Blockade (June 1948) as Soviet counter-pressure.

Item analysis

Standard

US.59 — Describe the competition between the United States and the Soviet Union in arms development, economic dominance, and ideology, including the roles of the United Nations, NATO, and the Warsaw Pact.

Standard

US.63 — Analyze the causes and effects of the Second Red Scare, including Americans' attitudes toward McCarthyism, blacklisting, House Un-American Activities Committee (i.e., HUAC), and Julius and Ethel Rosenberg.

DOK / Hess

Level 4 — Student must synthesize across multiple standards and sources, constructing an extended argument that connects US.61, US.59 through evidence-based reasoning requiring sustained analytical writing.

Reporting category

— (source of record: UNMAPPED)

IRT

a 1.44 · b 0.69 · c 0.0 (pre-field-test — estimates, not calibrated against student responses)

Format

classroom-formative (tcapFormat: false — item type is never TCAP-format under policy v1)

Bias / sensitivity

not-started

Citation

—

Historian review

not required

Distractor diagnosis

no misconception named — a distractor written to be merely wrong is noise, not diagnosis

Rubric

6-point

1. **6** — Precise, arguable thesis on the humanitarian/strategic duality. Full SOAPS analysis of both documents, identifying all five elements for each with historical accuracy. Outside evidence (minimum 3 specific facts). Addresses all three prompt components. Synthesizes the documents' dialogue to reveal structural Cold War incompatibility.
2. **5** — Clear thesis. Full SOAPS on both documents (may miss one element). Two pieces of outside evidence. Addresses two of three prompt components clearly.
3. **4** — Arguable thesis. SOAPS partially applied to both documents (3–4 elements per document). One specific outside evidence fact. Addresses two prompt components.
4. **3** — General thesis. Analyzes both documents but without systematic SOAPS. Some outside knowledge evident.
5. **2** — Basic claim. References at least one document, mostly summary. Minimal outside evidence.
6. **1** — Attempts a response. May reference documents without analysis.
7. **0** — No response or off-topic.